



Lead Organizations: NCI Network Trial Development and Conduct

Cancer Evaluation Program (CTEP) resources are used by investigators and lead protocol organizations (LPOs) in networks across NCI to develop and conduct clinical trials.

- Network Clinical Trial Site? [Click here for the new site resources landing page.](#)
- For AE reporting guidelines or the new CTCAE v6.0, [click here for the adverse events page.](#)



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CTEP Agents and Agreements

The NCI first signs a Collaborative Research and Development Agreement (CRADA) to develop and evaluate an agent under CTEP IND. Then, the agent will be added to the List of Available CTEP Agents for qualified investigators to propose pre-clinical and clinical research studies.

Available CTEP Agents

- [Available CTEP Agents](#) Webpage

- [Available CTEP Agents](#) (Excel Spreadsheet)

Industry Collaborations and Guidelines

CTEP has developed guidelines for the conduct of clinical trials under a collaborative agreement with a pharmaceutical or biotech company partner. The Lead Protocol Organization is responsible for ensuring compliance with these guidelines, including publication review, data access, and data sharing, as well as intellectual property licensing.

- [Industry Collaboration Guidelines for NCI Clinical Trials](#) (PDF)

More information about the CTEP Intellectual Property Option (CTEP IP Option) and model CRADAs, confidential disclosure agreements, and MTAs are available on the [CTEP IP Option and Agreements page](#).

Network-Specific Information

[PEP-CTN](#): Proposals for prioritization of an agent may be submitted to the PEP-CTN Agent Prioritization Committee from PEP-CTN members, COG Disease Committees, other academic research teams, and pharmaceutical companies. Proposals are initiated using the [PEP-CTN Agent Prioritization \(AP\) Proposal form](#) (Word). Questions about the AP Proposal form and requests for a Pre-Review Meeting can be addressed to: NCI-PEP-CTN@nih.gov. Consultation prior to submission of an AP Proposal form is encouraged.

LOI and Concept Development

Letters of Intent (LOIs)

LOIs for small cancer treatment trials using [available CTEP IND agents](#) can be submitted to the CTEP Protocol Information Office (PIO) by the grantee organization in the ETCTN, NCTN, PBTC, PEP-CTN, and AMC (US-only trials). NCTN, PBTC, and PEP-

CTN grantees can also submit LOIs proposing use of agents under their IND or for IND exempt trials.

- [LOI Submission Form](#) (MS Word)

Early-career investigators in the ETCTN and NCTN are encouraged to learn about applying to the [Career-Development LOI \(CRDL\)](#) program for priority consideration.

Concepts

NCTN Groups can submit concepts proposing larger cancer treatment trials to PIO. When a trial has an appropriate integral endpoint that needs additional support, a [BIQSFP \(Biomarker, Imaging, and Quality of Life Studies Funding Program\) application](#) can be submitted at the same time. BIQSFP applications for real-time integrated endpoints should be submitted after a concept has been approved.

- [Concept Submission Form](#) (MS Word)
- [BIQSFP Information and Forms](#)
- [NCTN AYA Checklist](#) for NCTN concepts/protocols that include Adolescent and Young Adults (AYA) (PDF)

CTEP Trial Development Timelines

CTEP's trial development timelines ensure that promising new therapies can reach patients without undue delays. Investigators may track their study's progress online, and CTEP staff work with investigators and collaborators during development to overcome obstacles to protocol approval and activation.

- [Background and overview of the OEWG Trial Development Timelines](#) for trial development and activation
- [Timeline Reports and Study Submissions Website](#): Track your study's progress through the trial development timelines and submit study documents electronically to PIO

Protocol and Informed Consent Development

Protocol Development

After an LOI or Concept is approved, the lead organization works on developing the trial protocol and informed consent based on the approved trial designs.

- [Protocol Submission Worksheet](#) (Word)

Additional notes for protocol design and considerations are below.

ETCTN Protocol Template

The ETCTN has support from CTEP's Central Protocol Writing Service (CPWS) to write these documents. CTEP's protocol template is required for protocols in the ETCTN under CTEP IND.

- [Generic Protocol Template](#) (Word) — updated September 26, 2025

Informed Consent Documents

CTEP provides an Informed Consent Template for use in all NCI-supported network trials reviewed by the [NCI CIRB](#) .

- [Generic Informed Consent Template](#) (Word) — updated November 27, 2018
- [Resource: Using Readability Tools](#) (PDF)
- [Resource: Recommendations about Attachments to the ICD](#) (PDF)

Informed Consent Side Effect Tables

CTEP also provides resources and information for the tables of side effects included in the CTEP Informed Consent Template: [Side Effect Tables for CTEP Informed Consent Documents](#) (html)

At this page, you can find resources for developing side effect tables for use in the CTEP Informed Consent Template and download CTEP-provided lists of side effects for commonly-used commercially-available cancer treatment drugs and regimens.

CTCAE and CTEP Codes

Common Terminology Criteria for Adverse Events (CTCAE)

CTCAE mapping information is provided here for lead protocol organizations. Additional CTCAE documents and resources are available on the [Adverse Events Reporting page](#).

CTCAE v6 is now available as an Excel file for lead protocol organizations. Implementation for CTEP/DCP studies is targeted for January 1, 2026. It will apply to newly opened studies only.

CTCAE Versions

- [CTCAE v6 \(2025\)](#) (Excel)
- [CTCAE v5 \(2017\)](#) (Excel)
- [CTCAE v4.03 \(2010\)](#) (Excel)
- [CTCAE v3.0 \(2006\)](#) (Excel)

CTCAE Legacy Version Mapping

- [CTCAE v3.0 to CTCAE v4.0 Mapping](#) (Excel)
- [CTCAE v4.0 to CTCAE v3.0 Reverse Mapping](#) (Excel)

Additional Codes

The below codes and links are provided as a resource for reporting and analysis for CTEP-supported trials.

Site Codes and Agent Codes - updated weekly on the CTEPcore website

- [CTEP Institution Codes](#)
- [Agent NSC Numbers](#)

Additional Codes

- [CTEP Simplified Disease Classification \(SDC\)](#) (MedDRA v10.0) (Excel) - July 2007
- [CTEP Pre-Existing Condition Codes](#) (MedDRA v10.0) (Excel) - July 2007
- [CTEP Prior Therapy Codes](#) (MedDRA v10.0) (Excel) - July 2007

Considerations for Protocol Development and Design

Considerations for Protocol Submissions

- **Active CTEP Registrations:** All study personnel listed on a protocol title page must have an active [CTEP registration](#) at the appropriate level. Failure to ensure all study personnel on the title page have active registrations can delay protocol approval.
- **Broadened Eligibility Criteria:** [CTEP's Broadened Eligibility Criteria](#) (PDF) should be used in all CTEP-supported network trials unless there is a strong protocol-specific justification for each more stringent criterion.
- **NCTN AYA Checklist:** LPOs should use the [NCTN AYA Checklist](#) (PDF) for NCTN concepts/protocols that include Adolescent and Young Adults (AYA).
- **NCTN Streamlined Data Practices:** IND-exempt phase 3 protocols should follow the [NCTN Streamlined Data Practices](#) (PDF).
- **Standard Language for Protocols Under Collaborative Agreement:** Protocols under CTEP IND provided under a Collaborative Agreement must include the [NCI/DCTD Standard Language for Protocols Under Collaborative Agreement](#) (Word).
- **Early Phase ETCTN Trials with Biomarkers:** LPOs should refer to the [Study Checklist for CTEP-Supported Early Phase Trials with Biomarker Assays](#) (Word).

CTEP Data Monitoring Methods and Data Reporting Responsibilities

The required data monitoring method will be communicated at the time of LOI or concept approval. Data Mapping Utility (DMU) reporting, either DMU Complete or DMU Light, is used for protocols under CTEP IND that require enhanced monitoring.

Requirements for DMU Complete and DMU Light reporting

- [DMU Complete Requirements](#) (PDF)
- [DMU Light Requirements](#) (PDF)

Protocols that precede the Data Mapping Utility may still be using **CDUS reporting**. The CDUS Instructions are provided for these legacy trials.

- [CDUS Instructions](#) (legacy document)

Overview of Data Elements Required by Monitoring Method (as applicable for a particular protocol)

Data Element	Demography	DMU Light	DMU Complete
Patient Demographics	Yes (via OPEN)	Yes	Yes
On/Off Treatment Status, Adverse Events		Yes	Yes
Treatment and Course Information		Yes (abbreviated)	Yes
Baseline Abnormalities, Dosing Information, Late Adverse Events, Response Data			Yes

Patient Drug Interactions Handout and Wallet Card

A Patient Drug Interactions Handout and Wallet Card must be provided as a protocol appendix for a trial of a non-marketed agent that has potential drug interactions.

- For studies under CTEP IND, the Handout and Wallet Card will be authored by CTEP PMB.
- For studies not under CTEP IND, the lead protocol organization is responsible for authoring the Handout and Wallet Card.
- Additional patient-specific fields in the Handout and Wallet Card are to be filled out by the site with the appropriate information for each patient.

Template and Instructions for Trials of Non-Marketed Agent(s) with Potential Drug Interactions: [CTEP Patient Drug Interactions Handout and Wallet Card](#) (Word)

After Trial Activation

After a CTEP-supported network trial activates, CTEP continues to monitor and support the trial in different ways.

Protocol Amendments

After CTEP has provided approval on hold or approval of a protocol document, each subsequent protocol amendment submission should include a summary of changes since the last CTEP-approved protocol.

[Summary of Protocol Changes](#) (Word)

Trial Status Information and Updates

Changing the trial status has implications across CTEP-supported trial systems. Make sure you understand the implications before making status changes.

- [Trial Status Information](#) (PDF)

Credentialed staff from the lead organization should make status updates for trials using the CTSU directly in the [CTSU Protocol Application](#) . For these trials, the only status that can be set by PIO upon request from the lead organization is the final Administratively Complete status.

Studies not using the CTSU should submit the Study Status Update Form to the appropriate PIO. Status updates must be made in a timely manner.

- [Study Status Update Form \(Non-CTSU\)](#) (Word)

Slow Accruing Trials

Enrollment to CTEP network trials is monitored to ensure it meets the projected accrual rates that were reviewed and approved as part of the trial development. Trials that are significantly below their projected accrual rates may not be able to complete enrollment in a reasonable timeframe. The CTEP Slow Accrual Guidelines describe how CTEP will evaluate accrual and what actions CTEP will require for slow-accruing trials. These actions may include:

- Corrective action plans

- Amendments to enhance enrollment or redesign of the trial to meet a more realistic accrual goal
- Termination of a trial that is not expected to complete enrollment

CTEP Slow Accrual Guidelines

- [Early Phase Trial Slow Accrual Guidelines](#) (PDF)
- [Slow Accrual Guidelines for Phase 3 Trials](#) (PDF)
- [Development of Slow Accrual Guidelines](#) (PDF)

Lead Organization Responsibilities for ClinicalTrials.gov Registration and Results Reporting

ClinicalTrials.gov registration and results reporting is required by law (Section 801 of the Food and Drug Administration Amendments Act, commonly called [FDAAA, and the Final Rule](#)) and NIH policy (the [NIH Policy on the Dissemination of NIH-Funded Clinical Trial Information](#)) for CTEP-supported clinical trials.

The Lead Protocol Organization (LPO) is responsible for ensuring the trials they lead comply with FDAAA 801, the Final Rule, and the NIH policy requirements for clinical trials registration and results reporting. This includes trials under CTEP IND.

[Lead Protocol Organization Responsibilities and Processes for ClinicalTrials.gov Registration and Results Reporting for CTEP-Supported Clinical Trials](#) (PDF) - June 2025

Ancillary Correlative and Biomarker Studies

Correlative Studies During the Trial

Investigators are encouraged to include judicious and evidence-based correlative study proposals in their LOI and protocol designs. These may be investigator-led, or may take advantage of one of NCI's biomarker development initiatives.

- Investigators developing LOIs may plan to conduct their own correlative biomarker studies with review and approval by CTEP's Biomarker Review Committee ([BRC Study Checklist for LOIs](#)).

- ETCTN Trials may request sequencing or pharmacodynamic assays through the [National Clinical Laboratory Network \(NCLN\)](#).
- NCTN Trials may apply for funding through the [Biomarker, Imaging, and Quality of Life Studies Funding Program \(BIQSFP\)](#).

Sharing Data and Specimens After Trial Completion

NCTN Trials

- Data from NCTN trials are shared in accordance with the [NCTN Program Data Sharing Policy](#).
- After NCTN phase 3 trials have completed and reported results, clinical data from the primary publication are submitted to the NCTN/NCORP Data Archive and made available for secondary research via [dbGaP](#).
- Remaining specimens will be listed in the NCTN Navigator website. Investigators can submit requests for specimens directly through [NCTN Navigator](#) and those requests will be reviewed by CTEP and/or by the [NCTN Core Correlative Sciences Committee \(NCTN-CCSC\)](#).

Sharing Data From CTEP-Supported Trials

- Data from CTEP-supported trials must be shared according to NIH policy, regulations, and applicable cooperative agreements and contracts.
- CTEP network grantees can share individual-level clinical and correlative data from published CTEP-supported trials in the NIH Database of Genotypes and Phenotypes (dbGaP).

Steps for CTEP Network Grantees to Share Data via dbGaP

1. Complete the [NCI dbGaP Study Registration Form](#).
2. Complete and obtain signatures for the [Institutional Certification form](#).
3. Email these two completed forms to the NCI CTEP Genomic Program Administrator (Grace Mishkin) at CTEPdbGaP@mail.nih.gov.
4. CTEP will review the submission and, if appropriate, register the study in dbGaP.
5. The PI and PI Assistant/Submitter identified on the study registration form will get an automated email invitation from the dbGaP Submission Portal.

6. Accept the invitation to begin finalizing the study information and submitting data. Refer to the [dbGaP Study Submission Guide](#) for instructions. For help with your submission, contact dbgap-sp-help@ncbi.nlm.nih.gov.